

CASE ID: 202409710002

EPISODE NAME: China Sanctions Calvin Klein

2024/09/24- Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Trade Practices (13)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Narrative:

On 2024/09/24, China announced it was investigating fashion retailer PVH Corp, the owner of Calvin Klein and Tommy Hilfiger, for their refusal “to source cotton from the Xinjiang region.”¹ China has already accused Calvin Klein of “boycotting cotton from its western Xinjiang region.”² The Xinjiang region is notorious for using the forced labor of religious and ethnic minorities to create textiles such as cotton.

On 2025/02/04, China added PVH Corp to its Entities List,³ for which PVH Corp said it was “deeply disappointed.”⁴ The Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act had already become law on 2022/12/23, making it illegal for PVH Corp to import cotton from Xinjiang.⁵

¹ Liu, Juliana. “China threatens sanctions on Calvin Klein owner over Xinjiang cotton boycott,” September 25, 2024, *CNN*, <https://www.cnn.com/2024/09/25/business/china-calvin-klein-sanctions-xinjiang-boycott-hnk-intl/index.html>.

² Leahy, Joe. “China threatens Calvin Klein owner with blacklist over Xinjiang cotton,” *Financial Times*, September 24 2024, <https://www.ft.com/content/0a5d7e21-0b9b-47c2-84c7-8757b46569ff>.

³ Bradsher, Keith. “China to Investigate U.S. Retailer, Sending a Message Over Xinjiang.” *The New York Times*, 24 Sept. 2024, www.nytimes.com/2024/09/24/business/china-xinjiang-calvin-klein-tommy-hilfiger.html.

⁴ “US Fashion Group PVH Says ‘deeply Disappointed’ over China Sanctions.” *FashionUnited*, 5 Feb. 2025, fashionunited.com/news/business/us-fashion-group-pvh-says-deeply-disappointed-over-china-sanctions/2025020564317.

⁵ Congress.gov (2022). “S.65 - Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act,” Sponsor: Sen. Rubio, Marco [R-FL] (Introduced 01/27/2021), Committee: Senate - Foreign Relations. <https://www.congress.gov/bills/117th-congress/senate-bill/65?q=%7B%22search%22%3A%22Uyghur+Forced+Labor+Prevention+Act%22%7D&s=6&r=1>.